

# Lessons

Moodle Lessons are an interesting way of interactive content delivery. For example, you can present to a student a scenario to work through, with each stage providing a series of choices. Each of these choices will affect the scenario going forward. If you are considering gamification of your Moodle course, Lessons are a Moodle Activity type you should consider.

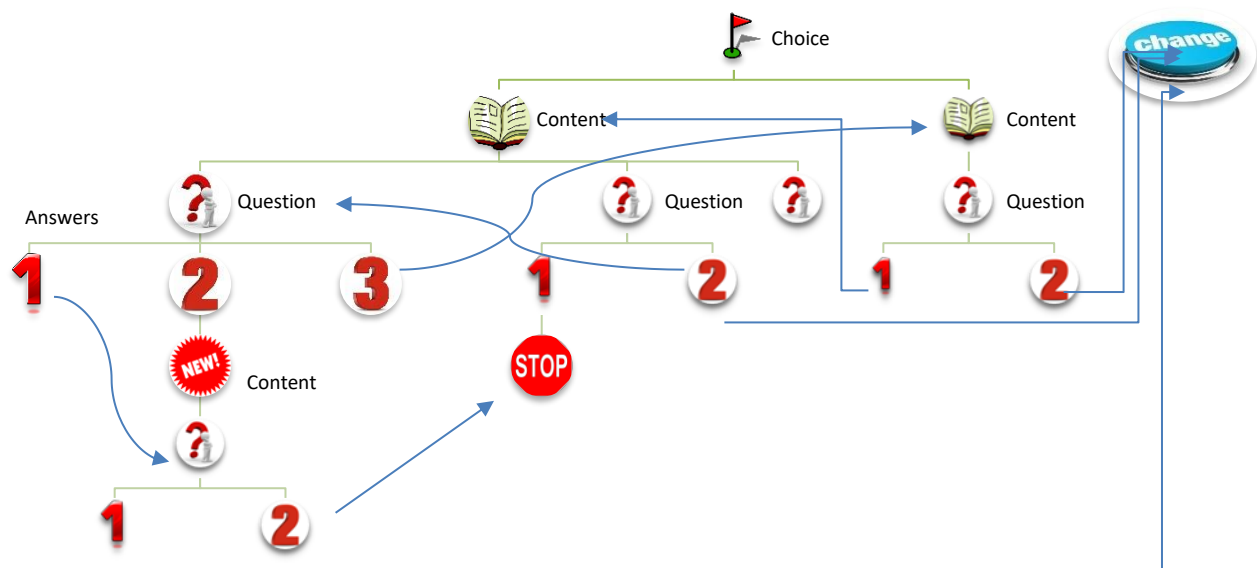
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## Planning your Lesson

“You need to have a clear idea beforehand of what you want to do with this lesson. Is it to be a graded, linear learning experience? Or an ungraded, non-linear practice session? Will students be able to go back and revisit areas or is it just a once-only opportunity?”

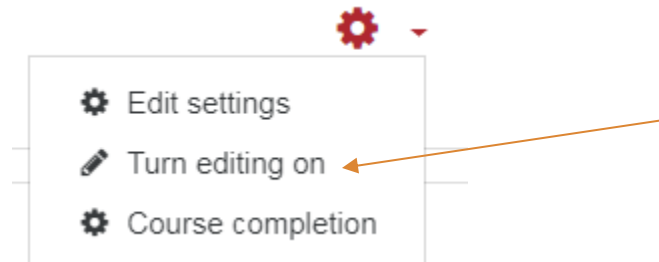
[https://docs.moodle.org/25/en/Building\\_Lesson#Planning\\_your\\_lesson](https://docs.moodle.org/25/en/Building_Lesson#Planning_your_lesson)



Think about doing a concept map to build your Lesson.

## Adding a New Lesson

1. Turn on editing by clicking the **Settings button** and then selecting **Turn editing on** from the dropdown menu.



2. Click on Add a Lesson

3. Give your Lesson a Name and Description (include directions).

4. **Appearance** (click the **Show more...** link to see all of the options below):

**Linked media:** A media file may be uploaded for use in the lesson. A 'Click here to view' link will then be displayed in a block called 'Linked media' on each page of the lesson.

**Progress Bar:** Students know their progress (percentage) within the lesson. (Suggestion-Yes)

**Display ongoing score:** Show score to students as they progress through a lesson.

**Display:** Students see their points (mark). (Suggestion-No)

**Display Menu:** Students can navigate pages through a Menu. (Suggestion-No)

**Minimum grade to display menu:** This allows students to navigate pages through a Menu if they obtained a grade on their first attempt. (Suggestion-No)

**Slideshow:** Lesson is shown as a slide show.

**Maximum number of answers:** This affects the maximum number of choices you can have on content pages (Suggestion- You should not have more than 4 answers- leave as default.)

**Use default feedback:** (Suggestion- it is nice in lessons to have feedback that is more relevant; especially when it can lead the students to another path.

**Link to next activity:** You can choose from the list of activities in your course.

5. **Availability:** Just like Moodle quizzes and assignments, decide if you are going to restrict access to the module by date, time and/or password.

6. **Flow Control:**

**Allow student review:** Student can go back and review the lesson.

**Provide option to try a question again:** If enabled, when a question is answered incorrectly, the student can try it again for no marks. They may also just proceed to the next page.

**Maximum number of attempts:** How many times a student is allowed to answer quiz questions in the lesson. If it is a formative assessment, please consider allowing multiple attempts.

**Action after a correct answer:** Options for how the lesson behaves once a student selects a correct answer.

- Normal - Follow lesson path
- Show an unseen page - Pages are shown in a random order with no page shown twice

- Show an unanswered page - Pages are shown in a random order, with pages containing unanswered questions shown again

**Number of pages to show:** This setting specifies the number of pages shown in a lesson. It is only applicable for lessons pulling from random pages – in this case, you may have 50 lesson pages, but you can set it so only 10 pages are shown. If set to 0, then all pages will be shown.

7. **Grade:** The grade settings are the same for an assignment. Consider these new settings:

**Practice Lesson:** *No/Yes* A practice lesson does not appear in the gradebook.

**Handling Retakes:** If re-takes are allowed, this setting specifies whether the grade for the lesson is the mean or maximum of all attempts.

8. **Common Module Settings, Restrict Access, Tags, Competencies:** Similar to other activities in Moodle.

### Building your Lesson

You may do the following to build your lesson:

1. Add content
2. Add questions
3. Create a cluster (a group of questions that may be randomly inserted into the lesson)
4. Import questions

This tip sheet concentrates on the first two: Adding content and questions.

## Adding content

1. In the Edit tab, click on **Add a content page**.

Preview Edit Reports Grade essays

Collapsed Expanded

Inserted page: Stephen Hawking's Early Life

| Page title                   | Page type | Jumps     |             | Actions                                                                                                                                                      |
|------------------------------|-----------|-----------|-------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Stephen Hawking's Early Life | Content   | Next page | ↑ ⚙️ 📄 🔍 🗑️ | Add a new page...<br>Add a new page...<br><b>Add a content page</b><br>Add an end of cluster<br>Add an end of branch<br>Add a cluster<br>Add a question page |

◀ Lab Journal

Jump to...

2. Add a title that will appear at the top of the page. Use your editor to add pictures, videos, text, and tables.

### ▼ Add a content page

Page title ⓘ

Page contents

↴ i ▼ B I ☰ ☷ 🔗 ⚙️ 🖼️ 📄 🎤 🎥 📄

☒ Arrange content buttons horizontally?

☒ Display in menu?

3. Add buttons at the bottom of the page. **Careful!** This can be confusing because the title to format the buttons is called content.

**Description:** This is what will be the words on the button at the bottom of the page.

**Jump:** This is the behavior that will happen once the button is clicked (where the learner will go after they click the button).

You can add multiple buttons. Here are two suggestions of when you would want to add more than one button:

1. You are asking the students a question. More readings on a subject? Ready for the test? Watch another video? This allows for self-directed learning.
2. You are allowing students to work through scenarios: What do you do? Each answer reflects a different page the students will go to, to continue their scenario.

## Adding Questions

1. Click on **Add a question page**.

The screenshot shows the Moodle Lesson editor interface. At the top, there is a table with columns: Page title, Page type, Jumps, and Actions. The first row shows 'Stephen Hawking's Early Life' as the page title, 'Content' as the page type, and 'Next page' as the jump. To the right of this row is a dropdown menu with the following options: 'Add a new page...', 'Add a new page...', 'Add a content page', 'Add an end of cluster', 'Add an end of branch', 'Add a cluster', and 'Add a question page' (which is highlighted in blue). Below the table, there is a 'Lab Journal' link and a 'Jump to...' dropdown menu.

2. Select the question type.

## Example lesson?

Select a question type

The screenshot shows a dropdown menu for selecting a question type. The options are: 'Multichoice' (highlighted in blue), 'Essay', 'Matching', 'Numerical', 'Short answer', and 'True/false'. To the right of the dropdown menu are two buttons: 'Add page' (in red) and 'Cancel' (in grey).

3. Click on **Add a Question Page**
4. Create **Page Title**
5. Under **Page Contents**, put your question
6. For each answer, Answer 1, Answer 2... **Insert an Answer, Response, Jump** (where the student goes next), and **Score**.

▼ Answer 1

Answer



Biologist

Response

Try again

Jump



This page

Score



0

▼ Answer 2

Answer



Theoretical physicists and cosmologists

Response

Correct!

Jump



Next page

Score



1

**7. Save Page.**

**Suggestion:** If this is a formative activity, have students return to a previous reading or slide or have them try the question again. Always give feedback.

What kind of scientist was Stephen Hawking?

☐ Theoretical physicists and cosmologists

☐ Biologist

Submit

## Ending your Lesson

To bring the lesson to a close, select the "End of Lesson" option from the Jump menu on any relevant pages. The student will then see a generic message as in the next screenshot, with a direction back to the main course page or to view their grades.

**Bonus feature of lessons: students do not need to restart!**

## Example lesson

You have seen more than one page of this lesson already.  
Do you want to start at the last page you saw?

## Understanding Flow Control

Settings > Edit settings> Flow control section

Here are some examples to help you understand the Lesson flow control settings. Please note the following:

- "Allow student review" setting applies to the review of a whole Lesson, whereas
- "Provide option to try a question again" setting applies to the review of an individual question page. When the student does not select the correct answer, 'Provide option to try a question again' setting will display 2 buttons. One will direct the student back to the question and the other to continue.
- "Maximum number of attempts" is designed to prevent a student from being stuck on "This page" where they continually put or select the wrong answer. It will override other settings, such as review or the option to try the question again. When exceeded, it will not allow a score to be recorded for that question.

## Case 1

The teacher wants the student to be able to attempt any question no more than 3 times and be given the chance to answer the question again. The teacher wants the student to see the response attached to their answer.

### **Flow control settings:**

Allow student review **Yes**

Provide option to try a question again **No**

Maximum number of attempts **3**

Display default feedback **No**

Number of pages to show **0**

Slideshow **No**

### **Student selects wrong answer and will see:**

"Response for the wrong answer" (if any is shown)

"Yes, I'd like to try again" button

"Continue" button.

### **Student selects correct answer and will see:**

"Response for the correct answer" (if any is shown)

"Continue" button

## Case 2

The teacher wants to allow the student 3 attempts at all questions but not see any feedback except the site default feedback for wrong answers.

### **Flow control settings:**

Allow student review **No**

Provide option to try a question again **Yes**

Maximum number of attempts **3**

Display default feedback **No**

Number of pages to show **0**



Slideshow **No**

**Student selects wrong answer and will see:**

"Not quite. Would you like to try again?" as text over the

"Yes, I'd like to try again" button

"No, I just want to go on to the next question" button

Note: If the wrong answer jump is set to "This page" and the number of attempts is under the maximum, then the student will return to the question, regardless if they select "No, I just want to go on".

**Student selects correct answer and will see:**

"Your answer: {gives the student's answer}"

Response attached to the correct answer (if any)

### Case 3

"Speed bump for speed clickers". Teacher only wants the student to get once chance to record an answer on any question. They will only see the response the teacher provides for any question, or the default feedback if no response has been set for the answer the student selected.

**Flow control settings:**

Allow student review **No**

Provide option to try a question again **No**

Maximum number of attempts **1**

Display default feedback **Yes**

Number of pages to show **0**

Slideshow **No**

**Student selects wrong answer and will see:**

"Response for the wrong answer" (if any is shown)

"Yes, I'd like to try again" button

"Continue" button.

Note: When teacher sets the Jump to "This page" for a wrong answer, they will return to the page but their score will not change.

**Student selects correct answer and will see:**

"Response for the correct answer" (if any is show)

"Continue" button

**For more information,** please contact Moodle Help at [moodle@norquest.ca](mailto:moodle@norquest.ca).